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On the Etymology of Latin *tranquillus* 'calm'

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§1. There are at least half a dozen proposals on record for the etymology of the Latin adjective *tranquillus* 'calm' [Plaut.+], one of which is widely accepted. The five major accounts can be sketched briefly as follows:

(a) < **trāns-liquillus*, cf. *liqueō* - *lūceō* 'be clear' and *trānslūcidus/trālūcidus* 'clear' (Bréal 1884:346, Bréal/Bailly 1885:401f.)

(b) < **trāns-qu(e)is-lo-*: **-qu(e)is-lo-* ~ OIr. *cíall* 'sense, perception' < **k^{μ}eis-leh$_2$* (: PIE **k^{μ}eis-* 'auf etwas achten', OIr. *ad-cí* 'sees', etc.) (Borgeaud 1967, 1969:145)

(c) < **trāns-quit-lo-*: **-quit-lo-* ~ Ved. *citrá-* 'bright' (: PIE **k^{μ}eit-* 'bemerken, erkennen', Ved. *cit-* etc.) (Borgeaud 1967)

(d) < **trām-queit-lo-*: **-queit-* < **-ḳ̑ueit-* (: PIE **ḳ̑ueit-* 'shine, be bright', Li. *šviečiù* 'id.', etc.) (Nyman 1979)

(e) < (i) **trāns-quī-lo-* or (ii) **trāns-quil-no-*: **-quī-lo-* = Gmc. **hwīla-* (Go. *hveila* 'Weile' etc.), to PIE **k^{μ}i̯eh$_1$-* 'ausruhen' (Lat. *quiēscō* etc.) (LEW s.v. *tranquillus*, with earlier references; see especially Vaniček 1881:318 and Muller 1926:493, both via **-quī-lo-*).

Of these, the "industry standard" is (e), in particular version (i), with its superficially attractive comparison to Gmc. **hwīla-* and (as also with version (ii)) to the root of Lat. *quiēscō*: this is the version presented in etymological compendia as received truth,[1] and (no doubt as a consequence) often referred to elsewhere as certain.[2] Yet Meillet – whose sensitive etymological judgments are to be respected – pronounced *tranquillus* to be a "composé expressif de formation obscure" (DELL, s.v.); and a similar skepticism has recently been voiced by M. Weiss, who observes that, while the first part of the word

[1] Besides LEW, also IEW 638, Watkins 2000:45 (but with a qualification: "Possibly Latin *tranquillus* ...").

[2] A recent example is Hackstein 2003:56.

does indeed seem to involve Lat. *trāns* 'across' (as nearly all agree), "the further analysis of *-*k*ʷ*illo-* is uncertain" (2007:257n33). In my view, this skepticism is amply justified, and every one of the above proposals is to be rejected. The remarks in **2.** should suffice to outline the essential weaknesses of these hypotheses, before offering a new approach to the problem.

§2. M. Nyman (1979:138) has already leveled cogent phonological and morphological arguments against Bréal's theory (1.(a)): the phonological reduction of **trānsliquillus* to *tranquillus* has no real parallel[3] and is probably unexpected (vs. **trānsli-* > /trāli-/, cf. *trāloquor* 'talk over', etc.); and the starting point operates with an adjective **(trāns)liquus* (or **(trāns)liquis*) that is itself unattested, and which was remade, most improbably, as a double diminutive.

In terms of semantics, Bréal's conception involved an original meaning 'clear, transparent' for *tranquillus*, and this feature is likewise fundamental to the proposals of Borgeaud (1.(b) and **1.**(c)) and to Nyman's own attempt (1.(d)). This claim arises from a single passage of Pliny the Elder (*Nat.* 37.153), where, in one version of Pliny's text, the corresponding abstract *tranquillitās* seems to have the meaning 'transparency' (instead of 'calmness'); and on this basis, Bréal and others after him have taken this to be the original meaning.[4] As it happens, this conception crucially depends on what is now considered to be an antiquated manuscript reading, no longer followed in any major edition of Pliny post-dating Bréal's original treatment (e.g. Jan and Mayhoff 1897, Eichholz 1962, Saint-Denis 1972). It is tempting simply to dismiss Bréal's idea on this basis; but the textual situation is more complex than has been suspected, and deserves to be presented in some detail.

The passage in question concerns the prediction of weather conditions at sea by examining stones (known as *cinaediae*, or *cinaedus* stones) found in the brain or skull of a certain fish.[5] The version of the text known to Bréal (and common in earlier editions, as in Detlefsen 1866-82) is as follows (with the passage at issue underlined):

[3] Nyman cites "*sembellus* from *semi+libellus*" [sic], i.e. *simbella* 'a half-libella (coin)' < **sēmi-lībella* (Varro, *L.L.* 5.174); but this has a different explanation, see DELL s.v. *lībra*.

[4] So also DELL, s.v. *tranquillus*.

[5] On animals and prognostication in Pliny (a recurring topos), see Beagon 1992:142ff.

Cinaediae inueniuntur in cerebro piscis eiusdem nominis, candidae et oblongae euentuque mirae, si modo est fides praesagire eas habitum maris nubilo colore aut tranquillitate.[6]

"*Cinaedus* stones are found in the brain of the fish of the same name; they are white and oblong, and have a remarkable effect, if one can believe the claim that they predict the condition of the sea, by means of their cloudy coloration or their clarity/transparency [*tranquillitate*, lit. 'calmness']."

The textual problem is discussed in detail by Nyman (1979:136ff.), who admits that all later editors follow the reading of **B** (the 10th-century "Bambergensis"), i.e. ... *habitum maris nubili uel tranquilli* 'the condition of the sea, whether rough [lit. cloudy] or calm', which "seems to ruin Bréal's crucial argument, because as an adjective attribute of *mare*, *tranquillus* would of course have its usual meaning 'calm'." Nyman goes on, however, to argue in favor of the older reading; and it must be admitted that he scores some points in its favor. First of all, he observes that the odd phrase *mare nubilum* 'a cloudy sea' (as in **B**'s *maris nubili*) is otherwise unattested, and in any case an unlikely way of referring to a 'rough sea' or 'stormy sea'. Secondly, the passage clearly calls for a "polar opposition", which Nyman takes to be between *nubilus* 'cloudy' and *tranquillitas* (allegedly) 'clarity, transparency'. The first point is well taken, and I believe it strongly supports Nyman's overall assessment that the text of **B** in this passage is not sound. Nyman is also justified in searching for a "polar opposition" in the passage; but his solution – the retention of the earlier reading *nubilo colore aut tranquillitate* – comes at a very high cost, namely the assumption that *tranquillitas* here (and *only* here, in all of Latin literature) carries a meaning quite unlike what it means elsewhere, and unlike all attestations of the adjective *tranquillus*, on which it must be based.[7] The provisional conclusion to be drawn, then, is that not only is the text of **B** unsound (specifically in its impossible phrase *maris*

[6] This is the reading of **d** (13th c.) and **h** (15th c.); **L** (13th c.) and **p** (1459) have *coloris*.

[7] I do not find persuasive Nyman's attempt (1979:136) to support this radical interpretation of *tranquillitas* by invoking semantic relationships between 'transparency' and 'calmness'; nor, despite Borgeaud 1969:146 (cited by Nyman), does the banal phrasing of Plaut. *Most.* 417 *ut liqueant omnia et tranquilla sint* 'so that everything becomes clear and is calm' provide real evidence for an original meaning 'transparent' for *tranquillus*.

nubili), but the vulgate seen in **d** and **h** is *also* unsound (specifically in its impossible meaning for *tranquillitate*). With respect to *tranquillitate*, moreover: the oppositional nature of the phrasing, on which Nyman rightly insists, leads one to expect not an abstract, but rather an adjective, agreeing with *colore*: ... *habitum maris, nubilo colore aut* X_{adj} *[*scil. *colore]* "... the condition of the sea, i.e. depending on their cloudy or [X] coloration". The passage, then, is deeply corrupt as transmitted, to an even greater extent than Nyman supposed. Yet a satisfying solution can be sketched. The obvious candidate for the missing adjective would be one meaning 'transparent', in opposition to *nubilo colore*. While most Classical authors prefer *pellucidus* (e.g. Hor. *C.* 1.18.16 *perlucidior uitro* 'more transparent than glass'), Pliny's favored term – well-attested in book 37 (heavily concerned with geology) and thus often with reference to transparent stones, as in this passage – is *tralucidus*: e.g. 37.129 (with reference to *crystallus* 'rock crystal'), 37.158 (with reference to the stone called *draconitis* or *dracontias*). The context of the first passage involves color (cf. *nubilo colore* in 37.153), i.e. characteristic tints (green, purple, gold) of *crystallus*; and the actual phrase *colore tralucido* is found at 37.56, in a discussion of one type of *adamas* 'diamond' (compared to *crystallus* in terms of its transparency).[8] Moreover, the discussion of *draconitis/dracontias* involves a stone which is said to "evolve from the brain of snakes" (*e cerebro fit draconum*) – cf. the *cinaedus* stones of 37.153, found *in cerebro piscis* "in the brain of a fish".[9] I suggest, then, that the corrupt passage (... *habitum maris,*) *nubilo colore aut* †*tranquillitate*† can be restored as *nubilo colore aut* <*tralucido*> (or possibly <*translucido*>) "depending on their cloudy or <transparent> coloration". The garbled versions in the vulgate tradition and in **B** would thus result from a marginal explanatory gloss on *tra(ns)lucido* [scil. *colore*] such as *tranquillitas* or *tranquillum*, mistakenly incorporated into the text (perhaps in part as a result of the similarity between ***tra(ns)lucido*** and [e.g.] ***tranquillitas***), and then, as often, gradually adjusted to the syntax of the passage in different ways. Thus, even though Nyman correctly, in my view, rejects the now-standard reading of **B**, a more nuanced understanding of the textual background of the vulgate tradition fails to provide support for

8 Cf. also *Nat.* 37.66 (cited also by Nyman, though for different purposes), where the color of emeralds is compared to the transparency of sea-water (*in colore ... imitante tralucidum maris* "in their color ... which imitates the transparency of sea-water").

9 Both 37.153 (*cinaediae*) and 37.158 (*draconitis/dracontias*) are found in Pliny's alphabetical disquisition on stones (37.139-192).

a meaning 'clear, transparent' for *tranquillus*, fundamental to the etymological hypotheses of Borgeaud and Nyman, and Bréal before them.

There are also formal problems (in addition to the basic semantic one just discussed) with Nyman's version of the 'clear, transparent' approach to *tranquillus*. There is no reason to think that the first member of *tranquillus* is an otherwise unattested root noun **trām-* – a suggestion that entails the intolerable claim, among others that need not be detailed here, that *inquit* 's/he says' is entirely unrelated to *insece* 'tell';[10] and despite Nyman, there is no phonological problem with the assumption that *inquit* and *tranquillus* both show the same reduction **-nsqu-* > *-nqu-*.[11] An attempt to rescue Nyman's idea by substituting **trāns-* as the first member would face the problem that his root **ḱu̯eit-* (not otherwise attested in Italic) provides no evidence for a **-lo-* formation, or indeed an *l*-formation of any kind, thereby reducing this hypothesis to a mere root etymology at best – and an unattractive one, given the basic semantic problem, as well as problems with the meaning of **trāns-* in such a compound, to be discussed below.[12]

Nyman himself provides an important counterargument against both versions of the standard account in 1.(e) (1979:133f.). This approach requires *trāns-* to be taken as an intensifier, with a meaning like 'very'; hence the compound would originally have meant something like **'very quiet', for which partisans of this theory cite the avatar of Lat. *trāns* in that meaning, namely French *très*. But this usage of *trāns* is an innovation of Gallo-Romance (Nyman cites Falk 1940), and even adverbial *trāns* 'beyond' is not attested until Vitruvius. It would be little short of preposterous, then, for a prehistoric compound of the sort shown by *tranquillus* to contain a first member with this kind of meaning for the ancestor of *trāns*.[13] Indeed, this consideration is to my mind almost fatal in itself for the standard account of *tranquillus*.

In both phonological and morphological terms, the version of this theory that operates with a construct **-quil-no-* (still retailed by the OLD, s.v. *tranquillus*) is nowadays unacceptable: a laryngeal-final root like **k^{μ}ieh$_1$-*

10 For further criticism of Nyman's **trām-*, see Russell 1988:151f.

11 On the morphology of *inquit, insece* and related forms, see Hackstein 1997:37ff., 42.

12 An assessment of Nyman's claims regarding **-t+l-* > Lat. *-ll-* (1977, 1979:141ff.) would add little to the present discussion, and can be left aside here.

13 As noted by Walde-Hofmann (LEW s.v. *tranquillus*), doubts on this point were already voiced in Leumann-Hofmann 1928:164.

cannot yield a short-*i* form /-quil-/ in any regular way; and the complex "Suffixhäufung", somehow involving both an *l*-formant and a *no*-stem, has no credible source. At first glance more attractive, both phonologically and morphologically, is the pre-Lat. **-quī-lo-* that would be directly comparable to Gmc. **hwīla-*. But the construct *trāns-* + **-quī-lo-* faces serious semantic difficulties, best reserved for discussion below (**4.**).

It remains to highlight an important *unproblematic* component of the standard theory based on a **-quī-lo-*, namely the assumption that pre-Lat. **-īlo-* could develop to *-illo-*.[14] Alternations of this sort involving stops are well-attested in Latin under the rubric of the so-called "*littera*-Gesetz".[15] But there is good evidence for a parallel phenomenon with liquids,[16] as seen in alternations of the type *vārus* 'knock-kneed' beside *Varrō*, *gnārus* 'skilled, expert in' - *narrō* 'narrate' (see DELL s.v. *gnārus*), or *pāricīda/parricīda* 'murderer'.[17] There is also, of course, the possibility of viewing some such instances of gemination as essentially expressive in nature (see Leumann 1977:182 on this point); and it should be noted that Lat. *tranquillus* itself could in theory reflect /-īllo-/, there being no evidence, either from Latin or Romance, for or against long [ī] in this word.[18]

§3. A more satisfying etymology of *tranquillus* emerges from consideration of the nature of the formation itself. Descriptively, and schematically, "**trāns-X-o-*" (> *tranquillus*) displays a thematic adjective based on a two-member compound, the first member of which is the preposition and preverb *trāns*. The unmarked analysis of such a formation would be in terms of one or another type of prepositional governing compound, in particular the so-called *profānus* type, with exactly the same format – that is, a compound adjectival formation in **-o-* (m./n.) / **-ā-* (f.) arising from a hypostasized prepositional phrase, as in *profānus* itself (*prō fānō* 'in front of [i.e. outside] the temple' → *profānus* 'unconsecrated'), and a number of other examples[19] – or alternatively the *ēgregius* type, with suffixation (*ē grege* 'out of the herd' + adjectival **-i̯o-* → *ēgregius* 'exceptional', etc.).[20] In other words, the "X" (in the schema **trāns-X-o-*) represents, historically, the noun in an original prepositional phrase beginning with *trāns*;[21] and the entire phrase will have had some sort of meaning appropriate to *tranquillus* 'calm'. Note further that despite the thematic outcome of the adjective, this original noun need not have been thematic itself (compare *perfidus* and *periūrus*, n. 19). As a first approximation, then, we must find a noun with a pre-Latin accusative singular shape like (*o*-stem) **quīlom*, (*ā*-stem) **quīlām*, (consonant-stem) **quīlem*, or (if one assumes geminate *-ll-* as the basis) **quillom*, **quillām*, etc.; and in the case of geminate *-ll-*, there will be a range of possible sources: **-ln-*, **-dl-*, and so on. But before presenting a specific proposal, we must return briefly to the semantics of *tranquillus*, including the question of the meaning of *trāns* in the hypothesized prepositional phrase.

§4. In view of the persistent claims that *tranquillus* primordially had something to do with 'transparency' or 'clarity', one must insist on the fact that the actual usage of the word in Latin has a primary "meteorological" reference, a point that has never been questioned. Nyman himself, in his attempt to defend Bréal's idea that *tranquillus* originally meant 'clear' or 'transparent', was forced to make a series of telling admissions about the meaning of the adjective. Fundamentally, he wrote, "*Tranquillus* is primarily a meteorological adjective" (1979:134). Furthermore, "in *tranquillus* the

14 To my knowledge, the "*tranquīlus*" cited at IEW 638 is not actually attested.

15 See e.g. Leumann 1977:183; in more detail Benedetti 1996.

16 Leumann 1977:182f.

17 So also *fēlāre/fellāre* 'engage in oral sex', *Messāla/Messalla* (Leumann 1977:183), **sārīre/sarrīre* 'hoe' (and, via the so-called *mamilla*-Gesetz [Meiser 1998:125], *sarīre*; see Garnier 2004:321). Cf. also *-ēla/-ella* (n. 53 below).

18 The Romance evidence is of no value, since all of the relevant items (e.g. Fr. *tranquille*) are late borrowings from Latin.

19 See Leumann 1977:402, and more recently Bader 2005:19f.; similarly e.g. *ā viā* 'off the track' → *āvius* 'trackless, untrodden', *sē dolō* 'without trickery' → (*sēdulō* 'diligently' →) *sēdulus* 'diligent', *per fidem* 'by an oath' (via phraseology like *qui per fidem decipit* 'someone who is deceptive even under oath') → *perfidus* 'treacherous' (cf. *periūrus* 'lying'), and many others. The type is likely to be Proto-Italic, given probable instances in Sabellic: see Heidermanns 2002:193f. on U. **anter:menzaru** 'new moon' (cf. Untermann 2000:109f. s.v.) and O. **u̯pfals** (nom.), **upfalleis** (gen.) etc. (PN; full listing of forms s.v. **u̯pfals**, ST p. 143).

20 Leumann 1977:290, further e.g. (*sub iugō* →) *subiugia lōra* 'yoke-straps' (Cato), (*ob noxam* →) *obnoxius* 'submissive'. This type, too, is likely to have a Proto-Italic pedigree: see Heidermanns 2002:194 on U. **ampeřia** and *presoliaf*, which may well reflect substantivized versions of this type of formation; on the interpretive and etymological details, see Untermann 2000:89, 575.

21 Similarly already Muller (1926:493): "Wohl Hypostase < *(in)trāns + quīlom*".

meaning 'clear, bright' is unattested" (1979:137); rather, "BRIGHTNESS OF WEATHER is only an occasional, etic feature in the 'semantic reading' of this lexeme", whereas "ABSENCE OF WIND (or, more generally, ABSENCE OF A DISTURBING ELEMENT) is an inherent, emic feature in the semantic structure of *tranquillus*" (ibid.). He notes further (1979:137n2) that *caelum tranquillum* means 'a windless sky', not 'a bright sky' (which would be expressed as *caelum serenum*).

Moreover, the abundant evidence of the texts (immediately apparent even from the range of citations in standard lexica like Lewis and Short or the OLD) makes clear that *tranquillus* refers first and foremost (and so probably in origin) to *calm weather conditions at sea*:[22] hence the substantivized neuter *tranquillum* 'a calm (at sea)' already by the time of Plautus, and the abstract *tranquillitās* in the same meaning [Cic.+], as well as a divinized *Tranquillitas*, attested inscriptionally, to whom one prays for good weather at sea.[23] And while metaphorical extensions to other states of 'calm' (such as a mental state) are already well-established in Plautus, the meteorological and even nautical basis of such extensions is still clear: e.g. *Poen.* 753 *tranquillitas* [scil. *animi*] *euenit quasi naui in mari* "a calmness [in his spirit] came about, just as for a ship at sea". For the meteorological usage, the salient point, once again (recall Nyman's observations just above), is the *absence of strong wind*, as could be demonstrated by numerous passages that it would be tedious to reproduce, easily accessible in the standard lexica.[24]

Now Lat. *trāns*, by nearly universal agreement, is a frozen participle to the PIE verbal root **terh₂-* 'cross over, overcome'.[25] Thus **trāns X* (in our hypothetical prepositional phrase, cf. **3.**), if it did not yet have the prepositional meaning 'across X' or 'beyond X' (as in attested Latin), might instead have had an "etymological" (i.e., true participial) meaning of the sort 'getting across/through X' or 'overcoming X', where X = *a storm, a gale, high winds,*

[22] Cf. explicitly Muller (1926:493): "Die wohl urspr[üngliche] Bed[eutung] 'ruhig' von der Meeresstille".

[23] For details on *Tranquillitas* 'Die Meeresstille als Gottheit', including the *ara Tranquillitatis* (CIL X 6643), see *RE* 12.2138 s.v., with references.

[24] E.g. Cic. *Clu.* 138 *ut mare, quod sua natura tranquillum sit, uentorum ui agitari atque turbari* "just as when the sea, which is calm by nature, is disturbed and roiled by the power of winds"; Livy 28.27.11 (neut. *tranquillum* 'a calm' opposed to *procellae* 'squalls, wind-storms'); etc. etc.

[25] See e.g. LIV s.v., n. 3; a dissenting view is discussed below, in **9.** (n. 62).

etc., leading naturally to an adjectival hypostasis with a sense 'calm'. It is for this reason, we can now add, that the traditional etymology based on a pre-Lat. **-quī-lo-* 'rest, quiet, pause' cannot be accepted, once the behavior of *trāns* as an intensifier is rejected (as it must be; **2.**): insofar as it would have any meaning at all, a **trāns-quī-lo-* could only produce something like the opposite meaning of what is actually required, i.e. nonsensical constructs like 'across or beyond rest/quiet' or (still worse, with "etymological" meaning) 'getting through or overcoming rest/quiet'.

§5. A final preliminary must now be presented, this time of a phonological nature. This consideration begins with the possibility (already mentioned [**2.**], and part of the standard theory as well) that the geminate *-ll-* of *-illo-* (in *tranquillus*) is a secondary development from an earlier **-ilo-*. Recalling the two morphological patterns described in **3.**, note first that for the *profānus* type, the original noun in question need not have been thematic itself, but is not likely to have been an *i*-stem (roughly **quīli-*), since this would have resulted in an *i*-stem adjective (cf. *finis* 'boundary' → *affinis* 'neighboring, related'). In contrast, the *ēgregius* type of formation does allow for a sequence **-īli-* (in **-quīlio-*), no matter what the morphological make-up of the base form was. If we then consider the possible sources of a Latin sequence /-īli-/, one of these is **-ēli-*, and in some cases of this kind, the source of **-ēli-* is **-esli-*, followed by the *s*-loss and compensatory lengthening that is regular for such sequences in Latin; thus, among other possible instances, Lat. *subtīlis* 'finely-woven' (cf. *tēla* 'web' < **tekslā*, and *texō* 'weave'). The raising of *-ē-* to *-ī-* in this context (and others) is much discussed, and not everything about the process is clear.[26] But the existence of the process is widely acknowledged,[27] and it can safely be invoked as a possible factor in the background of a pre-Lat. **-īli-*.

[26] On **-ēli-* > **-īli-*: Vine 1993:98-104 (with earlier references), arguing for an analysis in terms of *i*-epenthesis (cf. OLat. [Praen.] LEIGIBUS, CREISITA, and especially TRMEILI = Τρεμίλιος); more recently Meiser 1998:69 (also 174 on *mille* 'thousand' if < **smih₂-ǵʰesl-ih₂*), restricting the process to medial syllables, and advocating a conception based on vowel-weakening. (The two approaches are not in fact incompatible.)

[27] See recently Neri 2007:33n94, 71, on Lat. (perf.) *polīuī* and *polītus-* (< **po-lēu-is-*) 'polished' to **po-linō*, following Seldeslachts 2000:85ff., 106.

§6. With all of the above in mind, the following new proposal can be formulated concisely. The object of (the ancestor of) Lat. *trāns*, in the original phrase in question (**trāns X*), was an acc. sg. of the sort suggested in **3.**, such as *o*-stem **quēlom*, *ā*-stem **quēlām*, or consonant-stem **quēlem*. The background of this form can be further specified as follows (using the consonant-stem version for expository convenience): Lat. */quēl-/ < **kᵘēl-* < **kᵘezl-* < (Transponat) **kᵘes-l-* 'gale, squall, wind-storm', to PIE **kᵘes-* 'blow, pant' (Ved. *śvásiti* 'id.', Lat. *queror* 'complain', Eng. *wheeze*, etc.). Thus the participial (and not yet prepositional) phrase (e.g.) **trāns quēlem* would have meant (with "etymological" meaning for **trāns*) something like 'having passed through (or overcome) a gale'. This phrase would then have been hypostasized as an *ēgregius* formation, whence a **tranquēlio-*, an adjective that would have meant precisely 'calm' (especially at sea, and in particular due to the absence of strong wind).[28] This form **tranquēlio-* would then have been subject to the raising process just discussed (**5.**), resulting in **tranquīlio-*.

The development of this **tranquīlio-* to the attested *tranquillo-* is admittedly not easy to account for, although (as already noted) the shift of /-īl-/ to /-ill-/ would itself not be especially problematic. Given the possibility that <-illo-> of *tranquillo-* might also reflect /-īllo-/ (**2.** ad fin.), the difficulty recalls that of Lat. *mīlle* 'one thousand': as well highlighted by Sihler (1995:425), the spelling with geminate (for predicted †*mīle*) is unexpected. It is usually assumed (see e.g. Meiser 1998:174), perhaps correctly, that since <ll> in Latin otherwise spells a "clear" or "palatal" /l/ (so-called "/l/ *exilis*"), the geminate spelling in *mīlle* is merely a way of signaling the palatal quality of the /l/. It can be suggested, then, that Lat. *tranquillo-* (or perhaps actually *tranquīllo-*) likewise reflects a geminate spelling related to the palatality of the liquid – a feature even more marked in this form, which (at least descriptively) would seem to show the full "absorption" of the high vowel and palatal glide of the suffix into a palatal liquid (i.e. **-īli(i)o-* > **-īl'o-* or, with gemination, **-īl'l'o-*). Essentially the same phenomenon is well-documented for the Bantine dialect of Oscan (*allo* = Lat. *alia*, *famelo* = Lat. *familia*; Buck 1928:66), and is the standard development of such sequences in Romance

[28] O. Panagl (p.c.; September, 2006) offers the attractive conjecture that the original phrase might have belonged to nautical jargon, as is often assumed for the background of Lat. *cōnsīderāre* 'examine' (cf. *sīdus* 'star, constellation'); references and discussion in García-Hernández 1991 (who nevertheless argues for a different approach to the word).

(Lat. *folia* > /foli̯a/ > Ital. *foglia*, Fr. *feuille*, Port. *folha*, etc.), although clea examples from early or Classical Latin are not citable.[29]

Despite this phonological problem, the above hypothesis provides a prin cipled account of the attested meaning of the word, and does so in terms c a well-established derivational process in Latin that is directly related to th word's apparent form.[30] It would be desirable, however, to find independen support for two important components of this proposal: first (**7.**), the ide that PIE **kᵘes-* could indeed be used with a "meteorological" reference (qui te unlike, for instance, the meaning of Lat. *queror*); and second (**8.**), th assumption of an *l*-formation in the hypothesized pre-Lat. **quēl-*. We the conclude (**9.**) with some remarks on the implications of this theory for th historical background of Lat. *trāns* and its congeners.

§7. PIE **kᵘes-* is traditionally glossed 'sigh, snort, pant',[31] given th prominent attestation of such meanings for Skt. *śvásiti* and in the Germani material (as in Eng. *wheeze*), with the concomitant (and eminently reason able) assumption that meanings like 'complain' (as in Lat. *queror*) or 'lamen (as in TB *kwäsnätär*) are natural secondary developments of original sense 'sigh, snort' and the like. Yet the root is not restricted to various types c 'blowing' emitted by humans or animals ('sigh, snort', etc.), any more tha the other PIE 'blow' roots **h₂enh₁-* and **h₂uėh₁-* are restricted, in IE lan guages, to [+human] or [-human] 'blowing'.[32] One characteristic usage i the Rig-Veda refers to the 'hissing' of Agni's flame (I.65.8b-9a *agníḥ .. śvásiti*) – or so goes the traditional interpretation. But the 'gusting' or 'turbu lence' of a fire might instead be referred to, especially in collocations witl the clearly "meteorological" root *stan-* 'to thunder': I.140.5cd *yát ... **abhíś vasán stanáyann éti*** 'when he (= Agni) goes gusting, thundering'. Nor is thi

[29] Suggestive, but hardly conclusive, is the consistent spelling CAECILEIS (CIL I 3004a/b) for *Caecilieis*, in two versions of the same text (see Vine 1993:235n59 for th interpretation via palatalized /l'/ for /li/).

[30] Note, parenthetically, that the conception of the *ē* > *ī* process based on vowel weakening in non-initial syllables (n. 26 above) could also be applied here, if the pro cess operated on a sequence **tránquēlio-*, i.e. at a time when the prehistoric initi stress was still intact.

[31] E.g. LIV s.v. ('schnaufen, schnauben, seufzen'), similarly IEW 631 s.v. ('keucher schnaufen, seufzen'), Watkins 2000:45 s.v. ('To pant, wheeze').

[32] For **h₂uėh₁-* in a [+human] context, see Kölligan and Matić 2006 on Hom. *ἀωτέ ὕπνον* 'sleep'. I thank S. Neri for bringing this work to my attention.

usage restricted to Agni: VI.47.29a/30b *úpa* ***śvāsaya*** *pṛthivím utá dyā́m /... ní* ***ṣtanihi*** '(O drum,) make earth and heaven resound ("bluster"), ... thunder out', where the reference is to powerful atmospheric effects (as in a storm), and not mere 'hissing'.

The same usage is also found with the primary derivative Ved. *śúṣma-*: although many contexts seem to call for vague meanings like 'onrush, force, power', a sense '(stormy) violence, turbulence', or 'gust, squall (of rage)' could again be defended for some collocations with words for 'thunder' and 'lightning': VII.3.6c *divó ná te* ***tanyatúr eti śúṣmas*** 'your (= Agni's) turbulence comes like thunder from heaven', IV.10.4d *prá te divó ná* ***stanayanti śúṣmāḥ*** 'your (= Agni's) gusts thunder forth like those of heaven', VI.3.8b ***vidyún*** *ná davidyot svébhiḥ* ***śúṣmaiḥ*** 'he (= Agni) flashes like lightning with his own gusts'. Contextually possible meanings like 'hissing' or 'crackling' were likely present at some stage of Vedic transmission or even composition.[33] Yet the regular collocation of *śúṣma-* with *stan-/tanyatú-/vidyút-* suggests that we have to do, at least originally, with forceful, elemental 'blowing' appropriate to a storm. Indeed, it is difficult to understand how Ved. *śúṣma-* could have ended up with a general sense like 'power, violence' if the root on which it is based (recall the status of *śúṣma-* as a primary derivative) merely meant 'sigh' or 'pant', or even 'snort' or 'hiss'. It may be more attractive to assume that PIE **ḱu̯es-* properly meant something like 'blow (fitfully or violently), gust, as in a wind-storm' (as opposed, for example, to the unmarked root **h₂u̯eh₁-* 'blow', whence words for 'wind' in general). This meaning, in turn, would then have developed various specializations and bleachings, in part post-Indo-European, whence naturally 'pant, wheeze, snort, hiss' et sim., and eventually, in some traditions, meanings like 'complain' or 'lament'. Yet even without this conception, the Vedic material seems sufficient to demonstrate that a usage like 'blow (violently, as in a storm)' is a documentable and possibly archaic Nebenbedeutung (even if not the original Hauptbedeutung) of PIE **ḱu̯es-*; and if this is so, it is reasonable to expect that such a meaning might survive in a preliterary frozen expression of the sort hypothesized here to underlie Lat. *tranquillus*.

[33] So also, for various *śvas-* forms, with 'snorting' (*śvásīvān vṛṣabhó* "a snorting bull", I.140.10b), 'belching' (*jaṭhárād abhiśváso* "belching from his belly", X.92.8c), etc. Even here, however, the old associations are present: in the last-cited passage, *abhiśváso* in 8c (referring to Indra) is directly followed in 8d by *stann* 'he thunders'; cf. above on *śvas- + stan-*.

The Sanskrit material might even suggest a remarkable parallel with our hypothetical pre-Latin phrase **trāns quēlem*: a series of Vedic passages with *śúṣma-* in collocation with *turáyati* and *tiráti* could perhaps point to an archaic phraseological nexus of PIE **terh₂-* (as in both *trāns* and *turáyati/tiráti*) and **ḱu̯es-* (as in the proposed pre-Lat. **quēlem* and in *śúṣma-*):

III.37.10c	*út te* ***śúṣmaṃ tirāmasi*** 'we raise up your (= Indra's) power'
VIII.99.6a	*ánu te* ***śúṣmaṃ turáyantam*** 'after your (= Indra's) power, which presses forward'[34]
IX.19.7b	*ní* ***śúṣmaṃ*** *ní váyas* ***tira*** 'restrain, (O Soma,) his (= the enemy's) power, his force'

One could thus posit an underlying PIE collocation of the sort

**terh₂-*	+	**ḱu̯es-*$_{[nominal]}$
OVERCOME	+	STORM

using notation familiar from Watkins' analyses of similar two-part PIE collocations (1995 *passim*).[35] One need only add that the valence of the verbal root **terh₂-* might vary from one language to the next, depending on the use of different preverbs, the deployment of particular verbal categories (e.g. perfective vs. imperfective aspect), and so on. Thus, for example, Ved. *-tiráti* always occurs with preverb, and shows a generalized factitive meaning; one might say, then, that Rig-Veda IX.19.7b *ní* ***śúṣmaṃ ... tira*** (literally) 'overcome [i.e., abate] the storm' displays the automatic factitive equivalent of pre-Lat. ****trāns quēlem*** 'having passed through/overcome the storm'. But one need not insist on this phraseological reconstruction, as intriguing as the possibility may be. The essential point for our purposes, once again, is that the "meteorological" sense of PIE **ḱu̯es-*, posited above for this analysis of *tranquillus*, is transparently attested in the Vedic texts, and can be accepted as part and parcel of the meaning of the verbal root.

§8. The morphology of the pre-Latin sequence **ku̯ezl+* (as if from PIE **ḱu̯es-lo-*, **ḱu̯es-leh₂*, etc.) can be understood in various ways, depending on

[34] On the frequency of **terh₂-* in this hymn, see Watkins 1995:344f.

[35] Note further, in connection with the nautical background of *tranquillus*, Watkins comments on the "noteworthy" archaic examples of **terh₂-* in which "what is crossed passed over, is water" (1995:352).

which type of source form one believes to have been involved. Thus, one could in theory begin from a thematic deverbal adjective **ḱu̯es-lo-* or **ḱus-lo-* 'blowing', which might then have been substantivized, whence abstract or concrete 'blowing', and further specialization as 'storm'. To this it could be added that thematic adjectival **ḱu̯es-lo-* or **ḱus-lo-* would be roughly parallel to the **ḱus-mó-*[36] that may underlie Ved. *śúṣma-*, which has the appearance of a substantivized thematic *mo*-adjective, with the retracted accent typical of such substantivizations (conceivably also involved in the pattern presented above: e.g. **ḱu̯(e)s-ló-* 'blowing' [adj.] → **ḱu̯és-lo-* 'blowing; storm').[37] But this particular approach is ultimately not satisfying: there is no independent support for a thematic **ḱu̯(e)s-lo-*, which is thus, morphologically speaking, no better than Nyman's **ḱu̯eit-lo-*, apart from the fact that the root **ḱu̯es-* (unlike **ḱu̯eit-*) is otherwise attested in Italic. Much more interesting, however, may be a notional segmentation "**ḱu̯es-l-*", implying rather an original athematic *l*-stem – a formation that may have (at least indirect) external (**8.1.**) and internal (**8.2.**) support, although the derivational details (**8.3.**) are difficult to specify with precision.

§8.1. External to Latin, it is difficult to dismiss as coincidence the fact that the basic 'blow' root **h₂u̯eh₁-* itself makes an athematic *l*-stem – not a terribly common type of formation – that is probably reconstructable for PIE: cf. Hom. ἄελλα 'strong gust, wind-storm, whirlwind' < **h₂euh₁-el-ih₂* - W. *awel* 'wind, breath' < **h₂euh₁-el-eh₂*.[38]

Beside Hom. ἄελλα, there is also θύελλα 'id.' (*Iliad*+), usually thought to reflect nothing more than a rhyme-form to ἄελλα (from the root of θύω 'sacrifice'), generated at some point within the history of Greek (see GEW s.v.). But the meaning of θύελλα makes sense only in terms of the historical

[36] Or conceivably **ḱus-m[n]ó-* (to an original **ḱus-mḗn*? cf. perhaps Skt. [lex.] *śuṣman-* 'force, energy'), especially if one adds the Vedic demon *Śúṣṇa-* into the mix (*EWAia* II.649 s.v., Mayrhofer 2003:94, Ronzitti 2006:40); this is no more than a possibility, although the etymological figure at RV I.54.5ab is intriguing (*śvasanásya ... śúṣṇasya* "of the roaring ... Śúṣṇa").

[37] On substantivization via retracted accent, see e.g. Fortson 2004:120.

[38] Eichner 1973:85n6; on the vṛddhi formation (see Fortson 2004:116f. for this term), cf. Peters 1980:196n152, beginning from a **h₂uh₁-él* 'das Wehen, Wehende' (similarly Isebaert 1992:197). If the meaning of the Homeric form is archaic for this formation, the comparison with Latin (i.e. pre-Lat. **quēl-* 'id.') becomes even more striking.

(and not the synchronic) meaning of θύω (: PIE **dʰeuh₂-/*dʰu̯eh₂-* 'Rauch machen'); hence the word may be a relatively old formation, with a more complex background. Even if one disregards the uncertain "Illyrian" comparandum Δύαλος that is sometimes adduced,[39] θύελλα could in principle be aligned with other *l*-forms to this root in Greek, i.e. Hom. θυηλή 'burnt-offering', beside Ion. θυαλήματα and Att. θῡλήματα 'id.'. From a purely formal point of view, all of this material is readily interpretable in terms of a hysterokinetic *l*-stem[40]: **dʰuh₂-él* (→ θυηλ-ή),[41] **dʰuh₂-él-* (> θυαλ-),[42] **dʰuh₂-l-´* (> θῡλ-); and the weak stem **dʰuh₂-l-´* is perhaps also relatable to the *l*-formation (descriptively an *i*-stem, but perhaps hypostasized from a locative singular) that appears in the widespread **dʰuh₂-li-* 'ashes, soot' of Skt. *dhūli-/dhūlī-* 'dust, soil, powder', Lat. *fūligō* 'soot', Li. *dúlis* 'smoke-screen' (used in beekeeping).

One could even observe that *l*-forms are found with the other major PIE 'blow' root, namely **h₂enh₁-* 'breathe, blow', although these data have not previously, to my knowledge, been viewed in this way. Thus Ved. *ánila-* 'wind' (if it belongs with this root at all; see *EWAia* I.73 s.v.) is usually taken to be dissimilated from **ánima-* (comparable to Lat. *animus* 'spirit' and Greek ἄνεμος 'wind').[43] This type of dissimilation has few good parallels in Sanskrit, though a similar one (**-nm-* > **-lm-*) does indeed seem required for Arm. *hołm* 'wind'. Dissimilation is again sometimes thought to be involved in the background of TB *onolme* 'creature, (living) being' (see de Lamberterie, loc. cit.).[44] It would seem more attractive to assume, with

[39] See GEW loc. cit. and s.v. Δύαλος, with earlier references.

[40] The terminology used here to refer to the accent-ablaut classes of athematic nouns in PIE ("hysterokinetic", "amphikinetic", etc.) follows the standard system presented in Fortson 2004:107ff.

[41] With "feminization" of the type PIE **h₂éus-ōs* 'dawn' → pre-Lat. **au̯sōsā* (Lat. *aurōra*).

[42] A devī-form **dʰuh₂-el-ih₂* from this stem would have yielded ***θύαλλα* (if one assumes laryngeal coloring across the morpheme boundary), which could have been remodeled to θύελλα, after ἄελλα. (For the term "devī-form", see Fortson 2004:120.)

[43] See recently de Lamberterie 2004:318 on the Vedic, Armenian, and Tocharian forms treated in this paragraph.

[44] De Lamberterie is favorably disposed towards Rasmussen's (1988:170f.) analysis of *onolme* (**an-olmo-* < **an-* 'on' + **h₂olmo-* < **h₂on[h₁]-mo-*, i.e. 'he whose breath is on him'), but I concur with Adams (1999:115) that "the form and semantics seem more complex than is necessary".

many,[45] that *onolme* begins with the root *$*h_2enh_1$-* 'breathe', followed by the same suffix *-*olmo*- (> TB -*elme*, except in the rounding context provided by *onolme*) as in TB *syelme* 'sweat', *wpelme* 'web', and *yśelme* 'desire'. The background of this suffix is thus far unclear (so Ringe 1996:58). But if *onolme* continues an original *l*-formation,[46] this might help account for the origin and eventual spread of the suffix pattern within Tocharian – thus *syelme*, at least, seems clearly built within Tocharian to the root of *syā*- 'to sweat', the highly reduced TB result of PIE *$*su̯id-i̯(e/o-)$*. One could thus entertain the possibility of an original amphikinetic *$*h_2énh_1-ōl$/*$*h_2enh_1-(o)l$*- (+ *-*mo*-), a possible pendant to hysterokinetic *$*h_2n̥h_1-él$* (cf. the immediately following discussion).

Of interest in this connection are Lat. *anhēlāre* 'pant' and *hālāre* 'exhale', generally assigned to *$*h_2enh_1$*-, but with the assumption of original forms in *-*s-lo*- or *-*s-leh*$_2$ (whence denominatives *anhēlāre/hālāre*, with a secondary <h> of expressive or analogical origin).[47] All such approaches – including that of Schrijver – founder on the fact that, unless one wishes to operate with the problematic "*-*slo*-" as a derivational formant itself, there is no evidence anywhere for an *s*-stem *$*h_2énh_1-(e)s$*-.[48] One could consider, however, an original abstract or collective *$*h_2n̥h_1-él$/*$*h_2n̥h_1-(e)l$*- 'breathing': a thematic derivative *$*h_2n̥h_1-ēl-o$*- 'characterized by breathing' would directly give **anēlo*- → *anhēlus* [Lucr.+] 'out of breath', which, as Schrijver rightly observes, may reflect the basis of the denominative *anhēlāre* (rather than being postverbal, as sometimes assumed). A thematic *$*h_2n̥h_1-el-o$*- would give **anelo*-, whence **anlo*- by syncope and then **allo*- (as in, say, *bellus* 'pretty' < **du̯en-elo*-); a replacement of denominative **(h)allāre* by *hālāre* (~ *-hēlāre*) is perhaps not excluded (cf. also **2.** ad fin. on *Varrō/vārus* etc.).[49] Finally, the

[45] See recently Jasanoff 2003:157n24.

[46] Perhaps also *wpelme*? Cf. *l*-forms in Germanic and Baltic (OE *wifel* 'weevil', Li. *vābalas* 'beetle' etc., IEW 1115).

[47] See the discussion by Schrijver 1991:44f., with cogent critique of earlier accounts.

[48] The attempt by Fritz (1996) to support *s*-stem forms of *$*h_2enh_1$*- is not convincing; see the discussion by Stüber (2002:196f.). Schrijver's otherwise attractive theory operates with an unexplained double treatment of pre-Lat. **anaslo*-: (1) → *anhēlāre* (via **aneslo*-, without syncope); (2) → *hālāre* (via **anslo*-, with syncope).

[49] Alternatively, it may have been adjectival **allo*- (beside **anēlo*-) that was adjusted to **ālo*-; cf. the probable *hālōnem* (†*balonen*† P.F. 66.19L) 'hesterno uino languentem' ("hung over from yesterday's wine") often placed here (e.g. DELL s.v. *hālō*), perhaps

treatment of a *$*h_2n̥h_1-l-o$*- in Latin is unclear, but might well have been **analo*-, whence **allo*- and (as above) **(h)allāre/hālāre*.[50]

Based on these considerations, one might be able to defend the existence of old (or relatively old) athematic *l*-formations not only to *$*h_2u̯eh_1$*- 'blow' (→ *$*h_2(e)uh_1-el$*- 'blowing' [noun]), but also to the semantically related roots *$*d^heuh_2$*- 'produce smoke' (→ *$*d^h(e)uh_2-el$*- 'smoking' ?) and *$*h_2enh_1$*- 'breathe, blow' (→ *$*h_2(e)nh_1-el$*- 'blowing, breathing' ?). But in that case, one is led to ask which of these athematic *l*-forms – to which of the 'blow' roots – is/are "original", and which is/are modeled on the other(s)? A clear-cut decision is perhaps impossible; and I submit that in the end, it hardly matters: at least *$*h_2(e)uh_1-el$*-, which has a recognized claim to PIE status, helps support the existence of a parallel athematic *l*-form to the 'blow' root *$*ku̯es$*-, whether this *$*ku̯(e)s-el$*- was formed at some stage of the protolanguage, or later (as for instance in "Italo-Celtic", cf. W. *awel*).[51]

§8.2. The possible external support for an *l*-formation to PIE *$*ku̯es$*- can perhaps be supplemented by evidence internal to Latin. Among the primary abstracts in *-ēla* (OLat.+: *loquēla* 'speech', etc.) is the form *querēla* 'com-

originally 'the one who is exhaling (scil. foul breath)', with individualizing suffix (Fortson 2004:305).

[50] A *$*h_2n̥h_1-l-o$*- might instead have yielded **nālo*- → denominative **nālāre* – a form that could readily have been adjusted to *(h)ālāre*, given, on the one hand, the possibility of misinterpreting *n*- as a negative prefix (cf. *nōlō* 'I do not wish', *nullus* 'none' beside *ullus* 'any', etc.), and secondly the synchronic likelihood that *an(h)ēlāre* would be interpreted as built with a prefix *an*- (cf. *antestārī* [XII Tab.] 'call as witness' beside *testārī* 'id.' and 'act as witness').

[51] If an athematic *l*-stem *nomen actionis* is a truly archaic formation to this root, it would stand beside the isolated form seen in YAv. (Frahang) *suši* (du.) 'lungs', perhaps best interpreted as an agentive root noun (*'blowers'), though an *i*-stem is also possible (Klingenschmitt 1968:67, "*suš- oder *suši-"). (I thank Alexander Nikolaev for pointing out the morphological interest of this form.) Otherwise, an archaic action noun in *-*ti*- may well appear in Gk. κύστις 'bladder, (wind-)bag' (see most recently Adams 2006:394). The superabundance of PIE action noun and abstract noun formations is a well-known feature of the protolanguage; there is thus no difficulty with assuming both *l*-stem and *ti*-stem action nouns (beside a root noun or *i*-stem agent noun) based on the same root.

plaint, quarrel' [Plaut.+],[52] ostensibly based on *queror* 'complain', but possibly a formation of some antiquity.[53]

Since Benveniste's pioneering treatment in *Origines* (1935:42f.), Lat. *-ēla* has often been taken to continue a primary hysterokinetic formation in **-él*.[54] To be sure, parts of Benveniste's analysis must now be rejected: for example, as Melchert has shown (2001), the secondary type in *-tēla* (as in OLat.+ *tūtēla* 'guardianship') cannot have anything to do with Hittite forms in *-zzil* and Luvian forms in *-(t)til*, as Benveniste had thought. Yet the major alternative theory of Lat. *-ēla*, which interprets the formation as based ultimately on stems of second-conjugation verbs in *-ēre*,[55] has little to recommend it, despite superficially suggestive patterns of the sort *suādēla* [Plaut.+] 'persuasion' ~ *suādēre* 'persuade' or *candēla* [Varro+] 'candle' ~ *candēre* 'shine'. The problem is a complex one, and the details must be reserved for treatment elsewhere. It may suffice to note here, firstly, that the early Latin material shows no special predilection for *-ēre* ~ *-ēla* forms;[56] secondly, that the nature of the feminine **-lā* formation (in **-ē-lā*) has never been adequately explained;[57] and, finally, that Hittite may well provide at least one valid comparandum for a primary athematic *l*-stem in a form like *šuwil-* 'thread' (< **suh₁-él* or **suh₁-él*, to **s(i)euh₁-* 'sew'), as Melchert has

52 Plaut. *Cas.* 188; *Men.* 584 *ex coniectura* only (see Gratwick's apparatus, 1993:96).

53 See Leumann 1977:312 on confusion in the transmitted texts between *-ēla* and *-ella*, and the historical correctness of *-ēla* for the deverbative type *loquēla* etc. The same alternation, however, is attested more widely: see Leumann loc. cit. on *turbēlae/-ellae* 'disorder'; cf. also, among other such forms, *matēla/-ella* 'pot', *mūstēla/-ella* 'weasel' (on the suffix variation in the latter: Bettini 2000:10f. and especially Schaffner 2006:7ff., with extensive discussion of the general problem).

54 On **-él* (originally collective < ***-él-h₂?*) → **-ēlā*, cf. n. 41 above (Lat. *aurōr-a*, and especially *θυηλ-ή*); similarly **-ōl* → **-ōlā* (Hom. *φειδωλή* 'thrift', *εὐχωλή* 'boasting', etc.; Chantraine 1933:243).

55 See Leumann 1977:312, with further references; a recent advocate is M. Driessen (2003:357n14).

56 Among the primary forms: in addition to Plaut. *loquēla* and *querēla*, also *obsequēla* 'compliance'; note further the isolated OLat. *fugēla* 'flight' (Cato). None of these has a corresponding *-ēre* verb. (Lat. *contumēlia* ~ *tumēre* probably does not belong here, as discussed below, n. 60.)

57 Non-diminutive **-lo-/*-leh₂* (including **-eh₁-lo-*: Gk. *ἀΐδηλος* 'invisible', etc.) is essentially agentive (see Hackstein 2003:55ff.), which does not square well with the abstract (perhaps originally collective) value of Lat. *-ēla*.

discussed (2001:266).[58] Thus Benveniste's overall conception remains attractive and worthy of serious consideration. In that event, *querēla* itself – which (with one limited exception) is the only *-ēla* form with comparative *l*-credentials of any kind (cf. **§8.1.** on the possibility of a **ḱu̯(e)s-el-* 'blowing' beside one or more of **h₂(e)uh₁-el-*, **dʰ(e)uh₂-el-*, **h₂(e)nh₁-el-* '±id.') – might even constitute the *forme de fondation* for the whole type.[59] If so, *querēla* might then provide Latin-internal support for an athematic *l*-stem (in this case, a hysterokinetic **ḱu̯(e)s-él*), as hypothesized above for the background of pre-Lat. **ku̯ezl-* (> **-quēl-*, whence eventually Lat. *tranquillus*).[60]

§8.3. Morphological circumstances of the sort adumbrated here are not favorable for recovering the precise derivational and inflectional details leading from a prehistoric athematic *l*-stem (e.g. a hysterokinetic nom. sg. **kus-él*, in its "ideal" shape) to a pre-Lat. consonant-stem **ku̯ez-l-V* > **quēl-V* (e.g. gen. **quēl-es*, acc. **quēl-em*, etc.), for which more than one possibility surely exists. It does not seem difficult to assume, however, that the suffix form of the original weak stem (**kus-l-*) could have been generalized, along with the full-grade root of the corresponding present stem **ḱu̯és-e/o-* (> *queror*). Alternatively, the full-grade root (in the zero-grade context of a

58 As Melchert points out, plene spellings (*šu-ú-i-il*, *šu-ú-e-el*) at least point to suffix accent, hence the likelihood of a hysterokinetic formation. (I thank Craig Melchert for helpful discussion of the material in this section.) In a recent contribution (2007), E. Rieken has suggested that Hittite forms like *šuwil-* actually reflect thematic stems in **-lo-*, with a phonologically regular loss (or "absorption") of the final syllable. Even if this turns out to be correct for the Anatolian forms, it does not call into question the existence of PIE athematic *l*-stems as such or hysterokinetic stems in **-él* specifically, which would continue to be a viable source for the Latin *-ēla* formation.

59 Pre-Lat. **ku̯ezēlā* 'blowing, gusting' could easily have been adjusted to match the meaning of **ku̯éz-e/o-* (> *queror*), at some point after the verb had developed semantically from 'blow violently' to 'complain' (cf. Eng. *blowhard*, etc.).

60 The "limited exception" just mentioned is *contumēlia* 'insult, abuse', if this belongs with *tumēre* 'be swollen', to which various *l*-forms are sometimes compared (see e.g. Janda 2005:147ff., 155ff. on Σεμέλη and Ved. *túmra-* 'powerful', and further *EWAia* I.654 on Ved. *tumula-* 'geräuschvoll, lärmend' and Lat. *tumultus* 'commotion'). But *contumēlia* might instead belong with *contemnere* 'despise', *contumax* 'defiant' (: **temh₁-* 'cut', which lacks *l*-forms), on which see Rix 1997:881f. And if the form is an abstract based on an adj. **con-tum-ēlis* (so Leumann 1977:350, Rix loc. cit.), it need have no connection whatsoever with abstracts in **-ēla* based on an athematic *l*-stem.

hysterokinetic formation) could perhaps be explained via the acrostatic present **ḱu̯és-/*ḱu̯és-* that may be indicated by the Germanic forms (ON *hvæsa* 'hiss', OE *hwēsan* < Gmc. **hwēsjan*, cf. LIV s.v. **ḱu̯es-*, n. 1).[61] There are, at any rate, reasonable possibilities for explaining the pre-Latin formation required by the present hypothesis on the basis of an original athematic *l*-stem.

§9. The above proposal for the etymological interpretation of *tranquillus* has naturally focused on the background of the obscure second member *-quillo-*; but the proposal is not without interest for Lat. *trāns* and its cognates elsewhere in Italic (U. **tra**/*tra(ha)f*, *traha*, *trah-*) and in Celtic (MW adv. *traw*, prep. *tra*, etc.).

Recall first of all (cf. 4.) the general agreement that *trāns*, U. *traf* etc. continue a frozen participle to the verbal root **terh₂-* 'cross over, overcome', with *intrāre* 'enter' as a probable relative within Latin (see LIV s.v. **terh₂-*, n. 16). That, however, is where the agreement ends: most of the formal and functional details surrounding *trāns* are controversial, as is evident from any of the standard discussions.[62]

In terms of function, the central unresolved question is whether we have to do with a frozen present participle[63] or aorist participle.[64] Attempts to elucidate the diachronic development of *trāns* from participle to preposition invoke the possibility of reanalysis in phrases like *trans mare* *'crossing/having crossed the sea' (nominative participle, coreferent with main subject and governing a direct object accusative) reinterpreted as 'across the sea' (i.e., as a prepositional phrase, this usage then becoming generalized in such phrases).[65] This conception is plausible enough, as far as it goes; but a phrase like *trans mare*, no matter how far back into the past one wishes to retroject it, does not actually contribute to the question of whether *trāns*, in such original locutions, was historically present ('while crossing') or aorist ('having crossed'): depending on the context, an expression like *trans mare* could in principle go back to either one. In contrast, the reconstructed juncture **trāns quēlem* – the hypothesized precursor to the adjective *tranquillus*, which would preserve, as such, a fixed bit of archaic phraseology predating anything available from Latin texts – could well offer us a glimpse of the original participial force of *trāns*, which here clearly requires an aorist interpretation: i.e., 'having crossed through (or overcome) a/the gale', whence the adjectival hypostasis 'calm'.

If, finally, the functional value of *trāns* as an old aorist is thereby supported, this may eventually lead to more clarity with some of the formal details as well. An analogical solution is required one way or another, since neither **tr̥h₂-ént-*[66] nor **tr̥h₂-n̥t-'* can yield **trānt-* (or, whether directly or via Osthoff-shortening, **trant-*) regularly.[67] These complex problems must be reserved for future study; but we may at least be able to number Lat. *trāns* among other isolated relics of aorist active participles in Latin, as hitherto suspected for *clīēns* 'client', *parēns* 'parent', and *frequēns* 'crowded' (Meiser 2003:46).[68]

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61 In this event, Lat. *queror* itself could reflect a thematization based on the weak stem of the acrostatic present, which itself might be further supported by certain full grade forms in Indic (note especially pres. ptcple. RV *śvasánt-* [3x] beside *śuṣánt-* [1.61.10a], although the former is usually said to be innovative; see LIV s.v. **ḱu̯es-*, n. 2).

62 See, with further references, e.g. Schrijver 1991:224, LIV s.v. **terh₂-*, n. 3. In view of various formal and functional difficulties, Sihler (1995:95) rejects entirely the traditional interpretation of *trāns* as a frozen participle. Though some of Sihler's objections seem overstated, he rightly points out that a *present* participle, among IE languages, would be a "remarkable" source for a preposition (in contrast with, say, Lat. *aduersum/aduersus* 'towards'); cf. the following discussion.

63 So explicitly e.g. Hofmann-Szantyr 1965:251, and apparently Leumann 1977:540 (assigning *trāns* to *intrāre*, which he takes to continue an athematic root present; so also, tentatively, Schrijver 1991:405).

64 E.g. LIV loc. cit. (n. 62).

65 For the generalization of phrases like *trans mare*, note Hofmann-Szantyr (loc. cit.): "so oft bei Meeren, Flüssen, Bergen ..., jedoch stets in festen, wenig variablen Wendungen".

66 Cf. Lat. *tarentum* 'tomb'/*Tarentum* (place name), according to Watkins (1995:351) a thematized participle to the root present.

67 For "Osthoff-shortening" processes, see e.g. Fortson 2004:64.

68 Earlier versions of this paper were presented at the 138th Annual Meeting of the American Philological Association (January, 2007; San Diego, CA), before the Department of Linguistics at Hokkaido University (July, 2007; Sapporo, Japan), and at a meeting of the Indo-European Round Table of the Kyoto University Department of Linguistics (November, 2007); I am indebted to the auditors on those occasions for their helpful suggestions. I owe special thanks to Werner Knobl (Kyoto University) for his generous and learned counsel regarding the Vedic material in §7., to Sergio Neri (Jena) for stimulating comments on a preliminary sketch of the above material, and to the anonymous referees of *IJDL* for their thoughtful critique.

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